

had a conversation on Instagram that I'll never forget. One of my readers saw my post about how much invisible fees can cost you. She DM'd me, worried she was getting ripped off by paying her financial adviser's fees. I asked her how much she might expect to pay over the course of her lifetime. Her guess: around \$30,000. I showed her the real numbers: around \$315,000.

Did you catch that? She was actually paying more than *ten times* what she'd thought!

I then asked her if she could imagine spending the next thirty years feeling guilty about tiny expenses like coffee and dessert, while never realizing that none of those would add up to anything even close to that \$315,000 figure.

She couldn't believe it.

What a tragedy to turn fifty, sixty, or seventy, look back on your life, and realize you spent it obsessing over \$3 questions. You won the game that people told you to play, but you ignored what actually mattered.

Most of us spend our time asking \$3 questions when we should really be asking \$30,000 questions. Here are a few more of my favorite examples:

- » We agonize about buying a second phone charger, but then happily sign a thirty-year mortgage loan without running the numbers on whether or not we should even buy. (Hint: My decision to rent has made me more money than buying.)
- » We spend hours trying to decide whether to stay at a certain hotel on vacation, or if we can afford to splurge on a specific car, but never negotiate our salary.
- » And we write frantic emails to a certain personal finance guy, asking (in all caps), "ALLY BANK JUST DROPPED THE INTEREST RATE ON MY SAVINGS ACCOUNT BY 0.025 PERCENT! SHOULD I SWITCH?!"—but never realize that this equals less than \$2 per month. (I'm a little sensitive about that one after getting twenty emails per day for the last decade about interest rates.)